

Food is one area where my wife and I are not willing to sacrifice quality for cost. For health reasons, we choose to eat a mostly organic diet, high in produce, meat, nuts, eggs, and healthy fats and low in carbs and sugar. We eat almost no processed foods. Most people might think this is an expensive diet. And it can be. We tracked our spending very closely for a few months when we switched to this diet. We created a strategy to maximize quality and minimize costs. We began buying things like olive oil, coconut oil, nuts, and canned foods like peanut butter and beans in bulk from a warehouse store every couple of months. We buy most of our meat and produce from ALDI, a discount grocer. We use our local grocery store only to fill in the gaps for special ingredients that can't be found in the other two places. This strategy, combined with minimal restaurant meals, allows us to eat for about \$3 per person per meal. While not quite as good as Brad and Laura's \$2 per person per meal metric, we eat healthy gourmet quality meals every day for less than you could eat from the value menu at fast food restaurants.

Eating is a recurring expense we all have. Finding ways to optimize it will create considerable savings. It can also lead to a healthier lifestyle, which will save you money in the long run.

Other Recurring Expenses